7.3 Identification of Fabric by Look

Fabrics can be assessed by the appearance. This is generally based on how it takes up light and reflects or absorbs it. There are different types of fabric dull, bright, shiny, glossy, transparent, embellished, thick, heavy, light, fine, semi-transparent, embroidery, lace, knotted to mention a few.

Table 7.2 Different types of Fabrics and their Look

Name of the Fabric	Look
Denim	Dull
Silk	Shiny
Cotton	Transparent and Light weight
Wool	Hairy
Satin fabric	Shiny
Embroidered fabric	Rough
Linen	Coarse
Glitter print	Glossy
Velvet	Very smooth
Polyester (sari)	Bright
Woollen (Jerkin)	Soft
Pile fabric	Fibrous
Transparent fabric	Flimy
Carpet	Fleecy
Lace	Lacy
Bed	Quilted
Sweater	Ribbed
Denim (pant)	Stonewashed
Shiny legging	Stretchable



Figure 7.1 Different Types of Textile Materials

7.4 Grain



This is the term that explains the direction in which the fabric is woven. It determines greatly by the way the fabric falls on the object or the wearer. Understanding the grain helps in minimising the wastage and to create interesting fullness effects on the garment. Grain refers to the alignment of warp and weft yarns inside a fabric. When the fabric is selected for construction the grain line is analysed. When grain is not in the proper angle steps are taken to make it right. Also, diagonal grain is chosen when the design requires more flexibility for good fit or fullness for decoration. The common type of grain seen in garments is the straight grain. The main reason for this is, to get full strength for the garment which can be obtained when the garment is cut in the same direction as it was constructed. Apart from this, the perfectly twisted warp yarns that work like a skeleton on the fabric is very strong. The combination of that warp along with the weft will enable good compaction and better properties when cutting a garment pattern. In order to check if the fabric is on proper grain, one thread can be ravelled from selvedge to selvedge and then the fabric is folded on half. If this can create neat edge in the bottom, it is said that the material has been laid on proper grain. There are different types of grain which are explained below:

7.4.1 On Grain

Lengthwise grain means the yarn in the fabric runs in the length of the fabric and is parallel to the selvage. Crosswise grain

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